

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner with a decade of agile delivery in regulated environments.*

Positioning, hands-on Product Owner with ten years of backlog ownership, cross-functional stakeholder alignment, and delivery in regulated industries – available immediately.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY THIS ROLE

The posting describes full squad ownership across the product lifecycle, with particular emphasis on backlog discipline, refinement quality, and transparent stakeholder communication in a banking context – that is precisely the combination of responsibilities I have held in practice, not just in title. The explicit mention of SAFe as a desired framework signals a scaled delivery environment where coordination across tribes and squads matters as much as execution within one. Working in the Wertpapiergeschäft or a comparable regulated financial service with real compliance constraints is the kind of environment where structured requirements engineering and clean acceptance criteria are not optional hygiene – they are load-bearing.

That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not held a role inside a bank or securities house directly; my regulated-industry experience comes from a federal public authority, a defence programme, and an InsurTech SaaS platform serving primary insurers and reinsurers. The underlying mechanics are the same: compliance constraints, audit trails, multi-stakeholder sign-off chains, and zero tolerance for ambiguous acceptance criteria.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting, edge-case generation, acceptance criteria review
 - **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo implementation support and code review
 - **Cursor / VSCode**, LLM-assisted specification and rapid prototyping
 - **Lovable**, fast front-end prototype generation for stakeholder alignment
 - **Framer**, design-heavy prototyping and wireframe iteration
 - **Gamma.app**, structured stakeholder presentation and workshop material
 - **GPT**, research synthesis, backlog refinement support, stakeholder summaries
 - **n8n**, multi-agent workflow orchestration and process automation
-

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Django, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Helm, OpenShift, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Redpanda, MicroStrategy, Docker, GitOps, Shopware, AngularJS, Ionic, CGM API integration.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT THIS COMPANY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the squad in refinements and planning ceremonies, map the existing backlog structure against the tribe's roadmap commitments, and identify where acceptance criteria are thin or dependencies unresolved.

WEEK 2

Sharpen the backlog.

Run a focused backlog grooming cycle – prioritise by delivery risk and stakeholder urgency, write or rewrite the five to ten stories closest to sprint entry so they are dev-ready with clear acceptance criteria and no open blockers.

Own and close loops.

Take full ownership of sprint ceremonies, drive feature acceptance with fachliche Abnahme rigour, and establish a transparent status rhythm toward Tribe Lead and external stakeholders so delivery confidence rebuilds quickly.

I COVER LETTER

Sehr geehrte Damen und Herren,

ich bewerbe mich auf die Position als Product Owner in Ihrem Haus, vermittelt über SThree GmbH. Die Ausschreibung beschreibt eine Aufgabe, die ich in wesentlichen Teilen bereits in dieser Form übernommen habe: fachliche und technische Gesamtverantwortung für ein Squad, saubere Backlog-Steuerung, Moderierung von Refinements mit klaren Akzeptanzkriterien und transparente Kommunikation gegenüber einem breiten Stakeholderkreis einschließlich Fachbereichen, Delivery-Leads und Geschäftskunden.

Bei der Emil Group habe ich ein B2B InsurTech-Produkt in einem regulierten Umfeld als Product Manager verantwortet. Ich habe dort ein übergroßes 17-köpfiges Team in kleinere, eigenverantwortliche Scrum-Units aufgeteilt, Velocity-Tracking und strukturierte Refinements neu eingeführt und in einem prototypischen Produktzustand aktiv das Vertrauen der Kunden durch wöchentliche Product-Workshops zurückgewonnen. Die Arbeit mit Erstversicherern, Rückversicherern und Assekuradeuren hat mir ein konkretes Bild davon gegeben, was in regulierten Finanzprodukten mit langen Abnahmezyklen und hohem Compliance-Druck strukturell schiefgehen kann – und wie man es verhindert.

Bei Rohde & Schwarz habe ich im Rahmen des FCAS-Verteidigungsprogramms eine KI- und Daten-Management-Plattform für multimodale Datensätze verantwortet. Dort habe ich Features eigenständig von der User Story bis zum GitOps-Rollout geliefert, ein cross-funktionales Team aus Architekten, Data Scientists, Frontend- und Backend-Entwicklern sowie QA geführt und Deploymentzeiten durch Einführung von ArgoCD von mehreren Tagen auf 20 bis 40 Minuten reduziert. Das ist kein Backlog-Management aus der Distanz – das ist operative Mitverantwortung auf Delivery-Ebene.

Für das Wertpapiergeschäft oder vergleichbare regulierte Finanzumgebungen bringe ich keine direkten Vorkenntnisse aus dem Banking mit. Ich kompensiere das durch ein tiefes Verständnis der strukturellen Gemeinsamkeiten: klare Akzeptanzkriterien als Voraussetzung für Abnahme, audit-fähige Dokumentation, Stakeholder mit unterschiedlichen Zeithorizonten und eine Null-Toleranz gegenüber unklaren Anforderungen. Das sind dieselben Mechaniken, die ich in Behörden, Defence und InsurTech täglich angewendet habe.

Ich stehe ab sofort für ein erstes Gespräch zur Verfügung und freue mich auf den Austausch.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Hands-on Product Owner and Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience translating complex operational workflows into dev-ready requirements and shipped software. Regulated environments – InsurTech, defence, public sector – are the core of my delivery record.

Comfortable owning the full squad responsibility: backlog prioritisation, refinement quality, acceptance criteria, stakeholder communication, and feature sign-off. AI-native in daily execution, founder-level in pragmatism, low ego in team dynamics.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Backlog ownership and sprint discipline in scaled agile environments
 - Writing dev-ready user stories with unambiguous acceptance criteria
 - Cross-functional stakeholder management across business, engineering, and compliance
 - Refinement facilitation and product workshop moderation
 - Delivery ownership in regulated, audit-sensitive environments
 - Feature acceptance and quality sign-off under compliance constraints
 - Team restructuring and velocity recovery in stalled delivery situations
 - Transparent status communication toward Tribe Leads and external stakeholders
 - AI-native product execution and rapid requirements prototyping
-

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout

- Led cross-functional squad including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year
- Responsible for data transformation, transparency, and auditability with multinational stakeholders
- Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and audit trails with full data provenance

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered new features including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV) with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; standardised CI/CD with full test integration
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
- Designed interactive dashboards, tables, and community features (groups, networks, events)

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability; split a bloated 17-person team into smaller, effective Scrum units and introduced ownership and deputy concepts
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices lost under delivery pressure
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Led delivery of core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage
 - Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows with strict compliance constraints
 - Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity across legacy APIs and external databases
-

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Co-Founder & Product Owner

- Owned product architecture for quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware
- Defined USP: setup under two minutes, no technical knowledge required
- Served as deputy IT security officer; responsible for security architecture and attack vector mitigation

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Built group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone, including PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype
- Product later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE – ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Migrated internal webshop to Shopware including complex catalogue and API integration and configurable approval policies
-

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · [www.true-north.berlin](#) · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · FREELANCERMAP (AUFTRAGGEBER ANONYM) →